Using ESC Custom Blocks

Custom Blocks are ready-made ESC modules with their own editing controls. Add them to your email and update the content without editing code.

01 Start your email

Use the ESC template or your agreed starter email.

02 Choose your brand

Open **Email settings** at the top of the email and select your brand and footer logo.



Keep one Email settings block above the header. If it is already there, edit that block.

03 Add a block

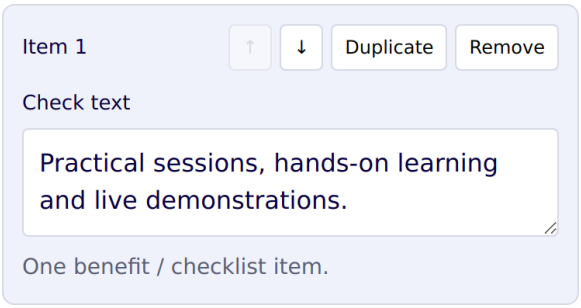
From the **Blocks** tab, drag an ESC Custom Block into a full-width content area. Use the block reference on pages 3–20 to choose a layout.

04 Make it yours

Select the block to edit its text, images and links. Use **Show…** switches for optional content.

For lists, use **+ Add item**, **Duplicate**, **Remove** and the arrows to manage entries.

Drag blocks to reorder them. Use the block actions to duplicate or delete them.



05 Save and check

Correct any highlighted fields and wait for **Saved in Content Builder**, then save the email. Preview on desktop and mobile, and send a test before approval.

Images, link options and final checks • page 2

Block reference: Newsletter • pages 3–12 | Congress • pages 13–17 | ESC TV • pages 18–20

Use the PDF bookmarks to jump to a block.

Screenshots show the supplied block editors and sample layouts captured outside SFMC. Brand colours and personalised content will vary.

Images and final checks

Use 1920 × 1080px for most content images, including both Congress lead modules.

Image	Recommended shape
Content images and Congress visuals	1920 × 1080px landscape
Speaker headshots	Square, with the face centred
Journal covers	Portrait, retaining the cover’s proportions
Logos and signatures	Original proportions; PNG for transparency

Adding an image

1. Upload it to Content Builder and copy its published image URL.
2. Paste the URL into the block’s image field.
3. Add alt text and the destination link.

Leave **image height in Outlook (px)** at **0** for automatic height in most cases.
If white lines appear around an image in Outlook, a manual height can help.
Aim below **1MB per image**.

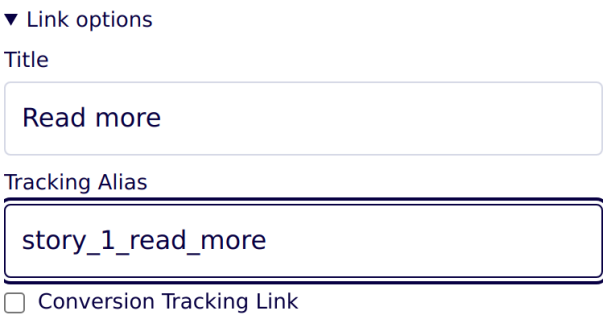
Link options

Expand **Link options** below a URL field, where available.

Tracking Alias: enter the reporting name for this link.

Conversion Tracking Link: tick when using conversion tracking already configured for the destination website.

Title: optional hover text.



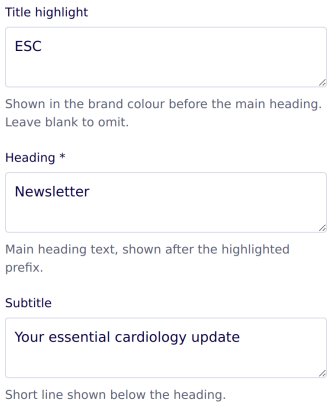
For a link in body copy, select it and choose **Add or edit link** in the text toolbar to access these options.

Before sending

- Replace sample content and check all links, dates and branding.
- Preview on desktop and mobile, including personalised content.
- Send a test, check Outlook and dark mode, and follow your usual approval process.

Newsletter openings

Decorative Header



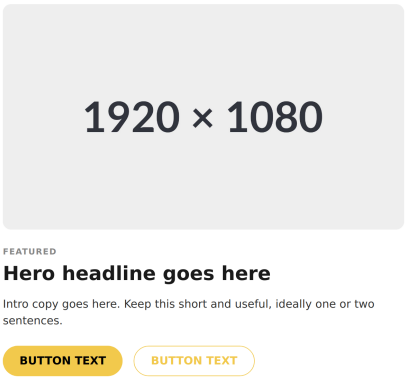
Editor controls

Branded newsletter heading.

Edit Title highlight, Heading and Subtitle. Leave Title highlight blank to omit the coloured prefix.

The logo and artwork follow the brand settings.

Hero Story



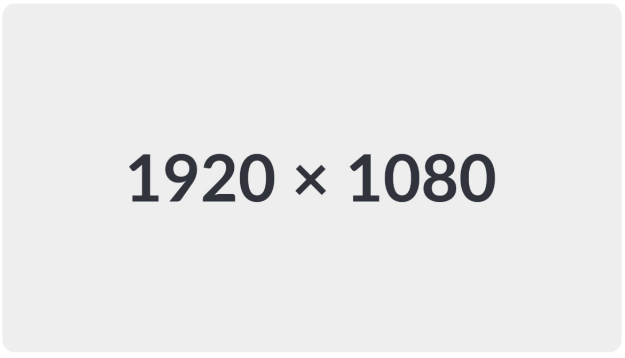
Lead story with a large image.

Add the image, headline, intro and links. Show or hide up to three buttons and choose their styles.

The top and bottom spacing switches adjust the gap to neighbouring modules.

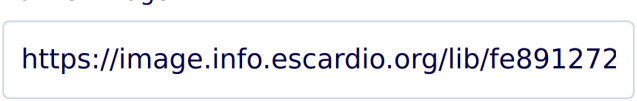


Image Banner



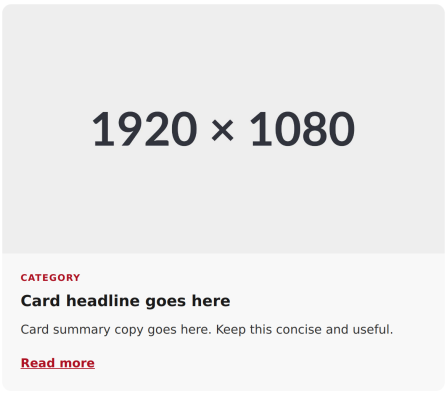
Linked image with rounded corners.

Set Banner image, its description and Banner link.



Newsletter story cards

Story Card 1 Col

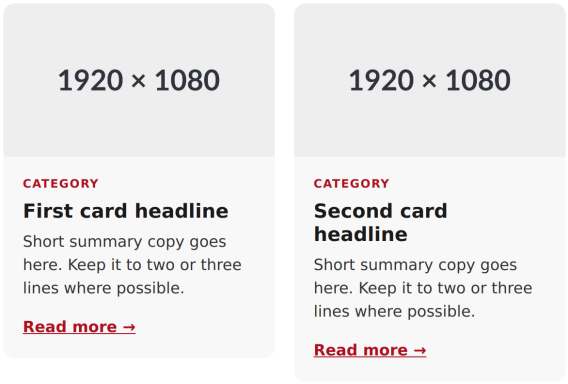


One full-width story card.

Add the image, headline and copy. Set the image and button links separately. Use the Show switches for optional content.

Show description

Story Card 2 Col



Two story cards.

Choose the light or dark Theme and complete both cards. Each has its own image, copy, links and Show switches.

Theme

Light background

Story Card 3 Col



Three compact story cards.

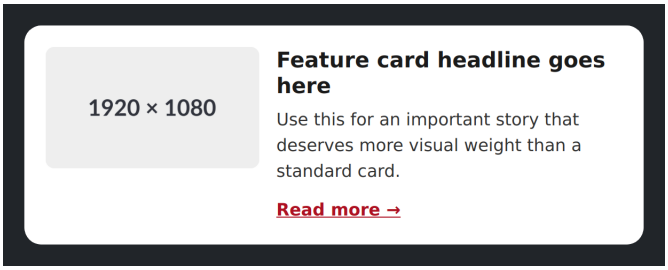
Choose the Theme and complete each card’s image, headline, copy and links. Descriptions and links can be hidden.

Link arrows are added automatically.

Card 1 show CTA button

Features webinars and video

Feature Card



Highlighted story with an image beside the copy.

Choose the Theme and add the image, headline and copy. Set the image and text links separately; hide the description or link if unused.

Theme

Dark background

Webinar Card



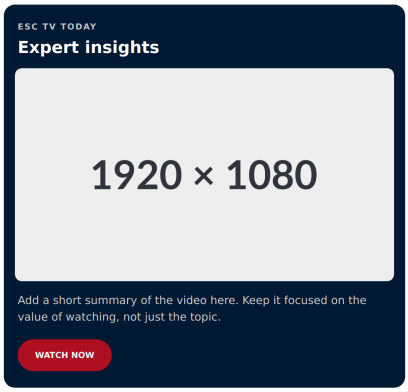
Webinar details and registration link.

Edit the heading, Date and time, image, alt text and button label. The image and button both use Webinar link.

Webinar link *

https://www.escardio.org/

Video Embed



Video promotion with a linked thumbnail.

Add the thumbnail, heading, description and button text. The image and button use Video link to open the video page.

Video link *

https://esc365.escardio.org/

Copy quotes and actions

Text Block

Text block heading

Use this module for simple editorial content, introductory copy, summaries or explanatory paragraphs.

Add a second paragraph here, or remove this paragraph when it is not needed.

Heading and up to two paragraphs.

Edit the Heading and paragraph fields. Leave any of these blank to omit them.

Paragraph 1

Use this module for simple editorial content, introductory copy, summaries or explanatory paragraphs.

Quote

> **“Add a short quote or editorial callout here.”**
>
> **Name Surname**
> Role or organisation

Quotation with an attribution.

Edit Quote text, Author name and Author role.

Author name *

Name Surname

CTA Banner

Call-to-action heading

Use this module for a strong final action, registration prompt or member benefit message.

BUTTON TEXT

Prominent banner with one button.

Edit Heading, Description, Button text and Button link.

Button text *

Button text

Navigation and section headings

Navigation

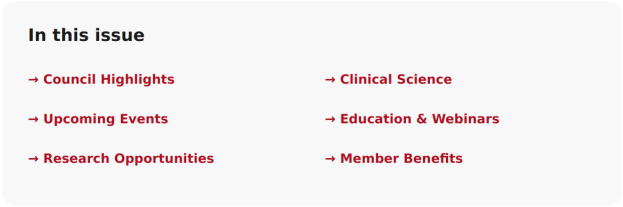
Row of navigation links.

Edit the link labels and destinations; add, remove or reorder entries.

Use full web addresses, or # links where the matching section destinations already exist in the email.



Table of Contents



Two-column list of links.

Edit Left column links and Right column links. Manage entries within each column.

As with Navigation, # links require matching section destinations in the email.

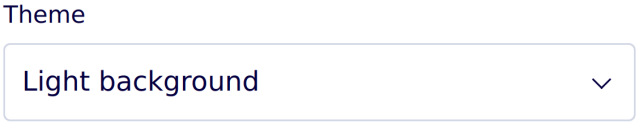


Section Header



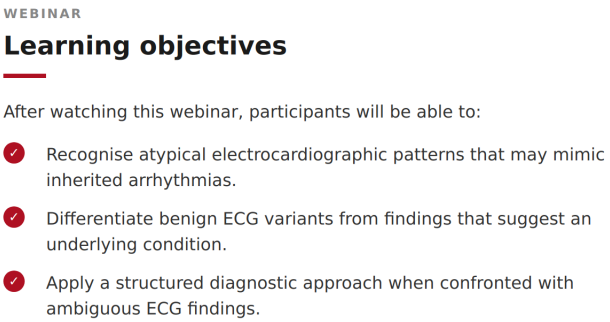
Newsletter section heading.

Choose the light or dark Theme and edit Section label and Section title.



Lists and events

Checklist

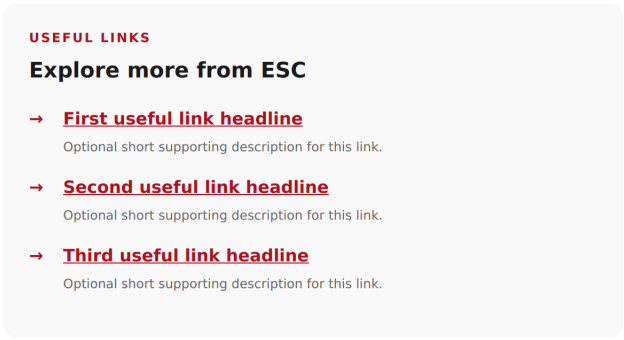


Learning objectives or benefits.

Edit the label, Heading, Intro copy and Checklist items. Checkmarks are added automatically.

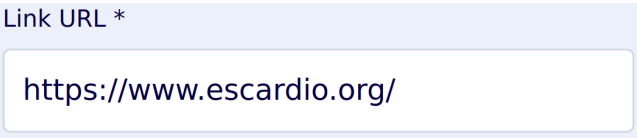


Link List

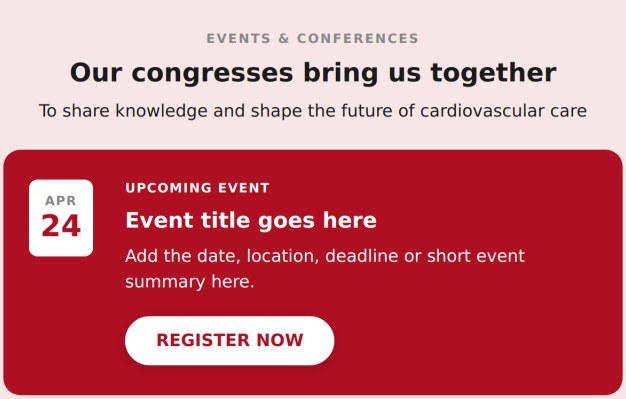


Related resources with optional descriptions.

Edit the category and heading, then each item’s Link URL, Link text and Description. Leave descriptions blank if unused.



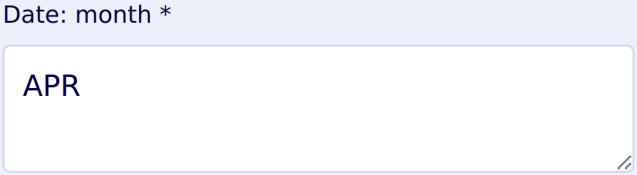
Events



One or more event cards.

Edit the intro and each event’s date, title, description and button. Use a short month such as APR.

Clear all three intro fields to omit the introduction.



Journals editorials and sponsors

Journal Section



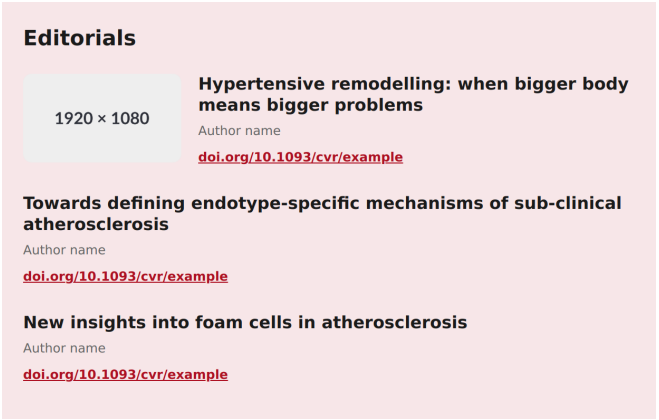
Journal issue promotion.

Add the cover, Journal name and Issue info. Set the cover link and button link separately.

Issue info

Volume 121 Issue 15 • 9 December 2025

Editorials



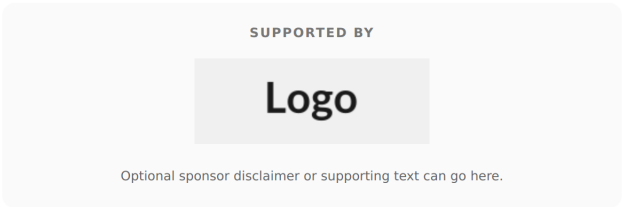
Article list with optional thumbnails.

Edit each entry’s title, author, link and DOI label. Leave Image blank for text-only entries.

Italic title applies to the whole title.

Italic title

Sponsor



Sponsor credit and optional disclaimer.

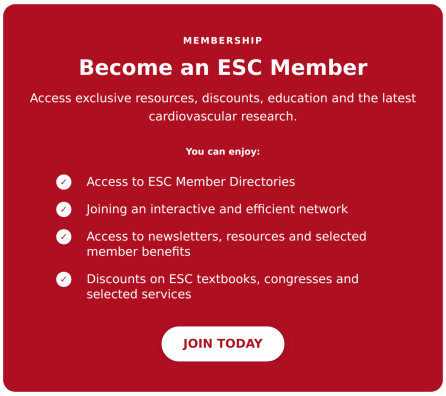
Set the label, logo, alt text, link and disclaimer. Leave the logo or disclaimer blank if unused.

Disclaimer text

Optional sponsor disclaimer or supporting text can go here.

Membership and signatures

Membership Callout

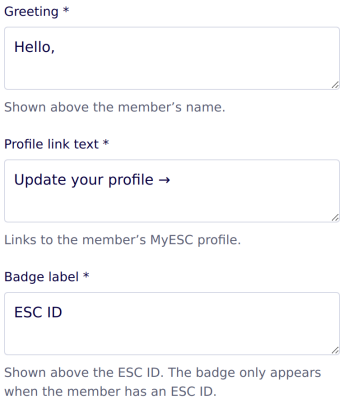


Membership benefits and joining link.

Edit the heading, description and benefits list, then set the button text and link. Show CTA button controls its visibility.

Show CTA button

Membership Card



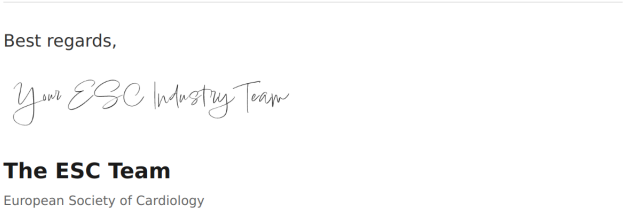
Editor controls

Personalised membership details.

Edit Greeting, Profile link text and Badge label.

Name, membership details and ESC ID come from send data. The ID badge appears only when an ESC ID is available.

Signature



Email sign-off with signature artwork.

Edit Signature greeting. If replacing the artwork, supply both the normal and dark-mode image URLs.

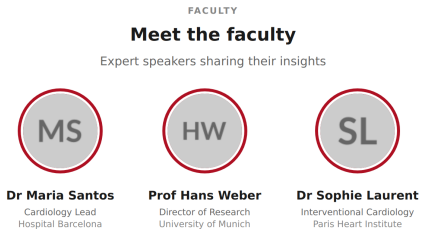
The image links to the brand homepage.

Signature logo image (dark mode) *

https://image.info.escardio.org/lib/fe89127277620d7570/m/1/88631b38-a22a-42fd-

People social and spacing

Speaker Grid



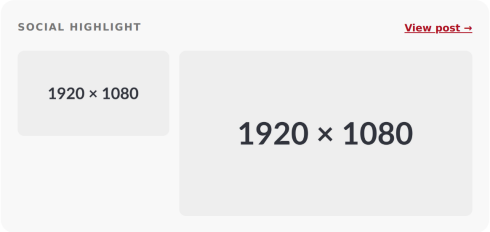
One to three speaker profiles.

Choose Number of speakers and edit the heading, subtitle and each profile's headshot, name, role and organisation.

Number of speakers

3

Social Block



Social post with two images.

Edit the label, images, alt text and Link text. Both images and the text link use Post link.

Post link *

https://twitter.com/ESC_Journals/status/154

Spacer

Spacer height *

24px

Restricted to multiples of 4px to avoid 1px rendering lines in Outlook.

Editor controls

Space between modules.

Choose Spacer height.

Divider

Divider style

Solid

Choose a solid or dashed line.

Editor controls

Line between sections.

Choose a solid or dashed Divider style.

Edge-to-edge images

Full Width Image



Editor controls

Image *

https://image.info.escardio.org/lib/fe89127277620d75

1920 × 1080px recommended; other heights are supported. Displays at 620px wide on desktop and scales proportionally on mobile.

Image alt text

Image description

Describe the image for screen readers.

Image link *

https://www.escardio.org/

▶ Link options

Where the full-width image links to.

Image height in Outlook (px)

0

0 = automatic (348px, to suit a 1920 × 1080px image at 620px wide). For another image shape, enter its displayed height at 620px wide in whole pixels, ideally a multiple of 4. Only Outlook for Windows uses this; other clients preserve the image proportions.

One linked image spanning the email width.

Find this block in Newsletter. It can be used in any ESC email.

Set Image, Image alt text and Image link. Use this layout for square edges with no side margins or extra spacing.

1920 × 1080px is recommended. Other image heights scale proportionally.

Leave Image height in Outlook (px) at 0 for the recommended shape. For another shape, enter the displayed height at 620px wide.

Link options

Image link *

https://www.escardio.org/

▼ Link options

Title

Tracking Alias

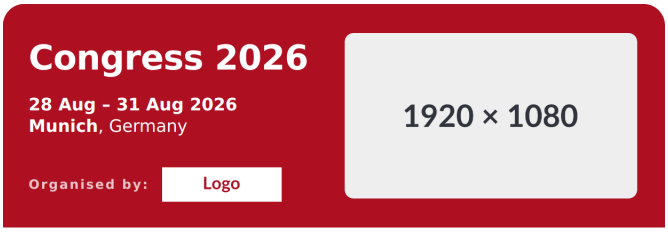
Conversion Tracking Link

Where the full-width image links to.

Unlike Image Banner, this block has no inset margins or rounded corners.

Congress lead modules

Lead Editorial



Congress details beside a visual.

Edit the congress details, organiser logo and main visual. Set the visual's alt text and link; show the format badge if needed.

Leave Mobile image blank to reuse the main visual, or supply an alternative.

Mobile image (optional)

Leave empty to use the main image. Supply an alternative only when needed; 1920 × 1080px is supported.

Mobile image alt text

Lead Poster



Congress details above a large visual.

Edit the badge, organiser label, congress name, dates and location. Add the poster image, alt text and link.

Organiser branding comes from the template.

Poster image *

https://image.info.escardio.org/lib/fe891272

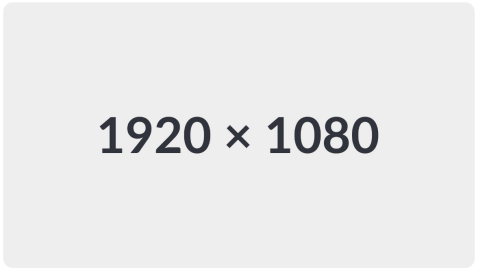
1920 × 1080px recommended. Scales proportionally to fit.

Poster image alt text

Congress key visual

Congress stories and headings

Story 1 Col



Add the main congress story copy here. This works well for introductory congress content, registration prompts, call for science messaging or programme highlights.

LEARN MORE

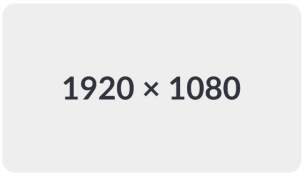
Full-width congress story.

Add the image, alt text, Body copy and Button text. The image and button both use Story link.

Story link *

https://www.escardio.org/

Story 2 Col

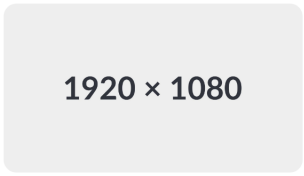


PROGRAMME

First congress story headline

Short supporting copy for the first congress story or feature.

Read more



REGISTRATION

Second congress story headline

Short supporting copy for the second congress story or feature.

Read more

Two congress stories.

Complete both sets of images, labels, headings, copy and button text. Each story's image and text link share its Story link.

Button text 2

Read more

Section Header

Section heading goes here

Congress section heading.

Edit Heading.

Heading *

Section heading goes here

Congress messages and actions

Personal Letter



Personal message from the congress team.

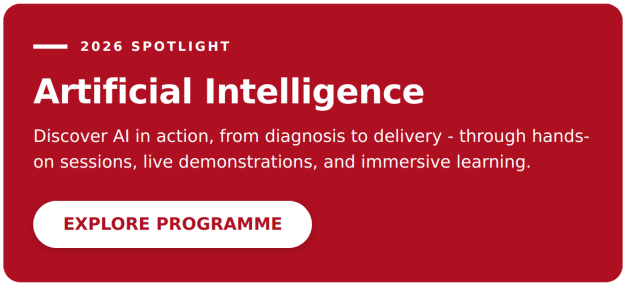
Edit the body, greeting and signature, leaving the %% personalisation markers unchanged.

Fallback greeting is used when the recipient's last name is unavailable.

Fallback greeting *

Dear colleague,

Spotlight



Featured congress theme or programme highlight.

Edit the label, Heading and Body copy. Set the button text and link, or turn off Show button.

Show button

Button Row



One to three buttons.

Choose the Theme and each button's text, link, style and colour. Use Show switches for buttons 2 and 3.

Brand colour follows Email settings; other colours are fixed.

Button 1 style

Solid

Congress lists and deadlines

Checklist

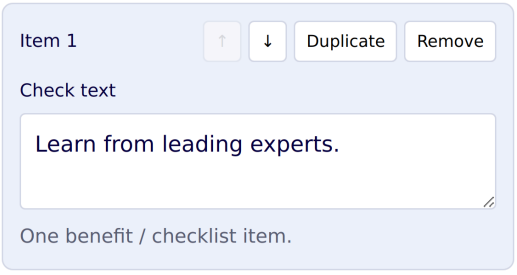
WHY ATTEND

Join the congress and benefit from:

- Practical sessions, hands-on learning and live demonstrations.
- Networking with peers, experts and the wider cardiovascular community.
- Access to the latest research, clinical updates and expert insights.

Congress attendance benefits.

Edit the label, Heading and Checklist items. Checkmarks are added automatically.



Deadlines List

KEY DATES

Don’t miss these deadlines

09 Dec 2025	Abstract submission deadline	Submit ›
28 Feb 2026	Late-Breaking Science submission	Register ›
15 Mar 2026	Early registration deadline	Book ›

Key dates with links.

Edit the label, Heading and each deadline’s date, description and link.

Reorder the rows to set the date sequence.



Together List

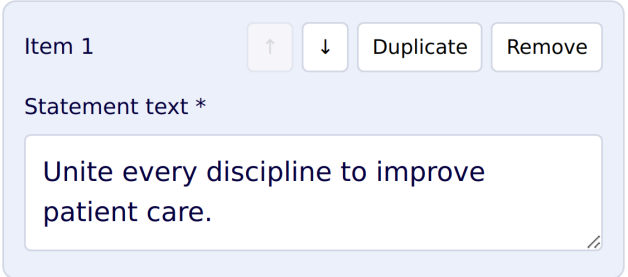
TOGETHER WE WILL

Transforming cardiology, together

1. Unite every discipline behind one powerful purpose: transforming patient outcomes.
2. Explore new science, practical learning and the latest developments shaping cardiovascular care.
3. Celebrate the human connection that drives discovery, collaboration and clinical progress.

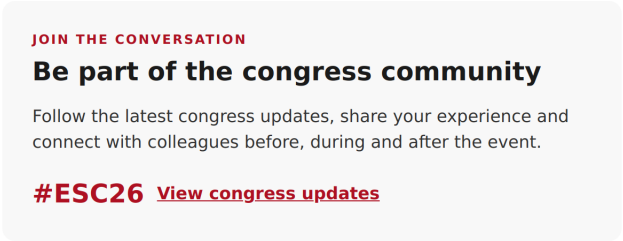
Numbered statements or shared aims.

Edit the label, Heading and statements. Add, remove or reorder entries; numbering is automatic.



Congress community and attribution

Conversation



Congress social updates.

Edit the heading, copy, Hashtag, Link text and Link destination. Include the # in the hashtag.

Hashtag

#ESC26

Shown large next to the link, e.g. "#ESC26".

Link destination *

https://www.escardio.org/

▸ Link options

Link text

View congress updates

Attribution

Attribution text

In collaboration with the European Society of Cardiology.

The organiser name and logo come from send personalisation and are not editable here.

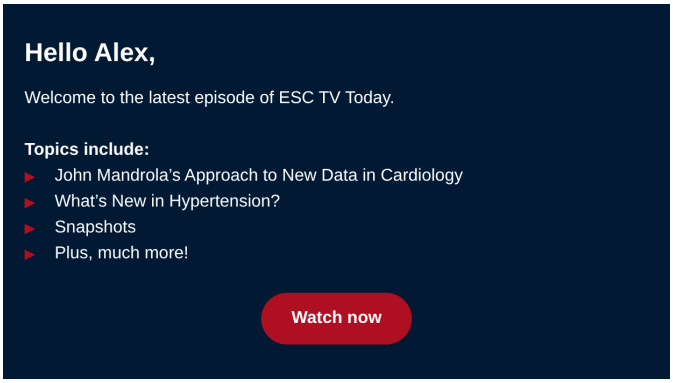
Organiser or collaborator credit.

Edit Attribution text. The organiser name and logo come from personalisation.

Editor controls

Introductions and stories

ESC TV Lead



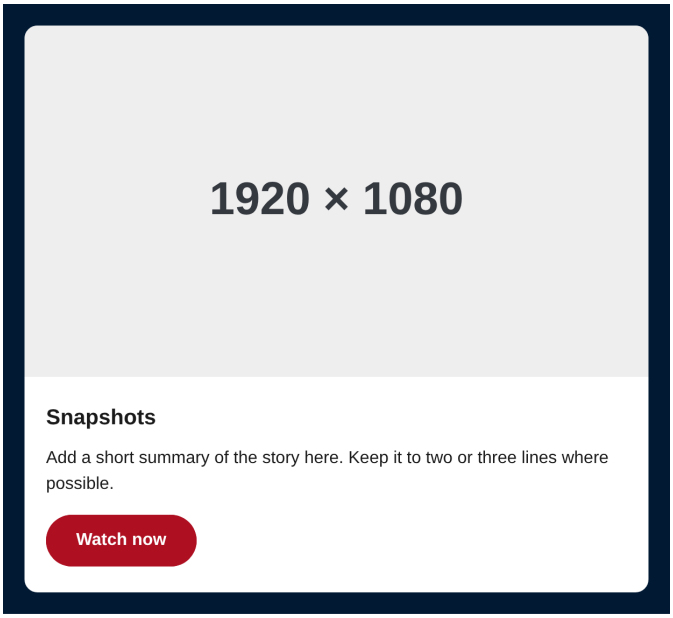
Personalised opening, topics and a button.

Edit Greeting, Fallback greeting and Body copy. The greeting supports first-name personalisation, with a fallback when a name is unavailable.

Edit the topic list using + Add item, Duplicate, Remove and the arrows. Use Show topic list and Show button to include or hide these sections.

Set Button text and Button link. Brand settings supply the button colours.

ESC TV Story Card



One image-led story on a white card.

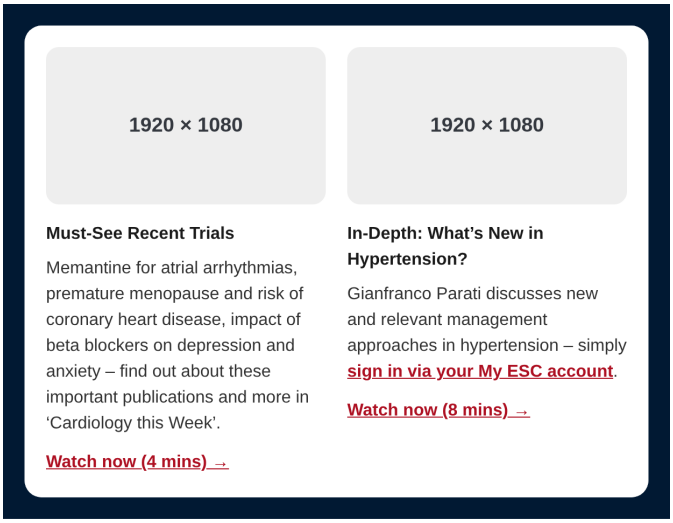
Add Card image, its alt text and Card image link. Edit the Headline and Description.

Use Italic headline, Show description and Show button to choose the content. Set Button text and Button link separately from the image link.

Use 1920 × 1080px for the image. Keep the Outlook height at 0 unless a different image shape needs a manual value.

Two-column stories

ESC TV 2 Col



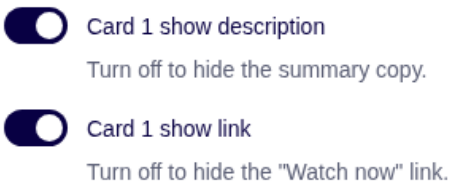
Two stories in one card, stacking on mobile.

Complete each card separately: image, alt text, image link, headline, description and link text.

Card 1 and Card 2 have independent Show description and Show link switches, plus an Italic headline option.

Set each image link and story link independently. Use Link options for tracking alias, conversion tracking and optional title text.

Editor controls — card 1



Images and proportions

1920 × 1080px is recommended. Leave each Outlook height at 0 for the default shape; enter its displayed height when using another proportion.

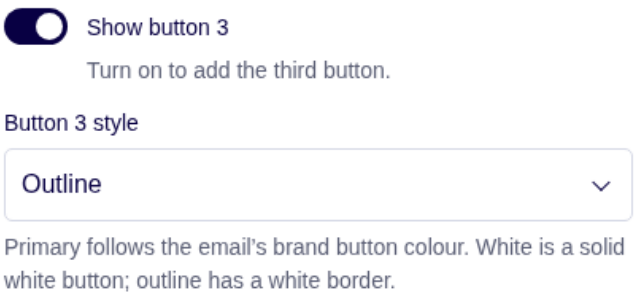
The layout contains two fixed cards. Use a separate Story Card block when you need a single story.

Preview both cards on desktop and mobile. Longer headlines and descriptions increase the card height.

Buttons and disclaimer

ESC TV Button Row





Editor controls — button 3

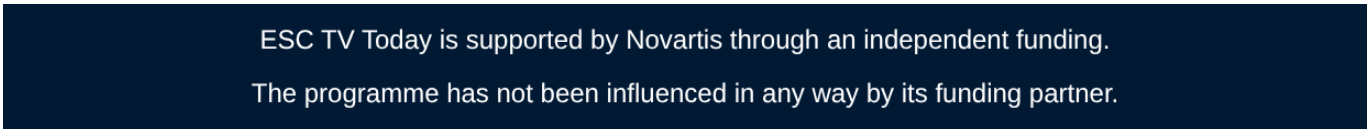
A row of up to three linked buttons.

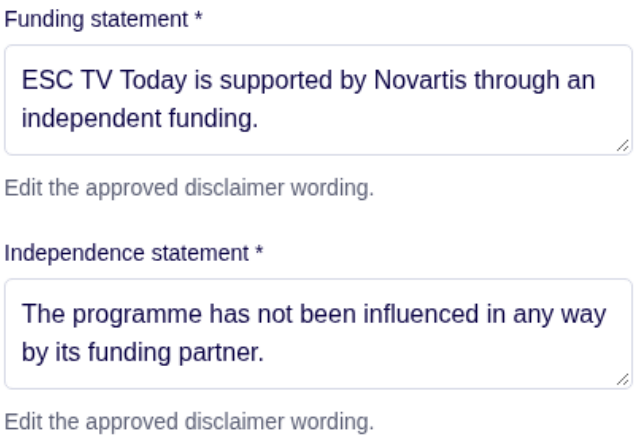
All three buttons are shown initially. Use Show button 2 and Show button 3 to hide them when not needed.

Edit each label and destination. Choose Primary (brand colour), White or Outline for each button. On mobile, the buttons stack.

Each button link has the same tracking and title options described on page 2.

ESC TV Disclaimer





Editor controls

Funding and editorial independence wording.

Edit Funding statement and Independence statement. Both fields are required.

Use the approved wording for the programme and its funding partner. Check both statements before sending.

The two statements stay centred in white on the ESC TV navy background and wrap naturally on mobile.